

Product Strategy Proposal: VibeCircle App

1. USER PROBLEMS

A. Money and Earning Problems

- **The Earning Paradox:** Creators work very hard but earn less than ₹1,000 a month because they can't reach the huge follower counts (like 10k) that big apps require. On YouTube, creators also need a fixed number of watch hours. Instagram influencers require a substantial follower base to secure promotions from brands. This makes them feel frustrated every day.
- **Skills Not Reaching Buyers:** Local, talented youth, such as gym trainers or artists, have no place to teach or sell to people nearby. They can't compete with big, expensive English courses meant for people in metro cities.
- **Cultural Gap:** Most apps feel like they were made for English speakers in big cities. People in Tier-2 towns feel like "outsiders" because the apps ignore their local language and culture.
- **Hidden Local Content:** Good local videos get buried under national viral trends. Users can't find creators from their own town, and follower numbers often feel fake.
- **Only the Top 10% Earn:** Most of the money goes to the biggest creators. There is no way for regular people to earn small amounts (like ₹10–₹100) from their work.

B. App Experience and Social Problems

- **No Local Search:** There is no easy way to find local food spots or events in cities like Tier -2 cities, even though young people spend a lot of time on social apps.
- **Hobby Blindness:** Algorithms show viral content but ignore interests like digital art or exam studies. This forces hobbyists to leave and go to other apps.
- **Scrolling vs. Belonging:** Apps are made for endless scrolling, not for making friends. There are no "digital groups" for local creators to hang out in.
- **Technical Friction:** No "Lite" mode for people who have limited mobile data in smaller towns.
- **Safety Issues:** There is a lot of bullying and bad words in local languages. This causes 50% of female creators to stop posting content.
- **Sign-up Failures:** SMS codes for logging in often don't arrive on slow networks in smaller towns. This makes 40% of people give up during sign-up.
- **Unresolved Reports:** Thousands of reports about scams are ignored, which makes users feel unsafe.
- **Switching to Global Apps:** People are using the app less because global apps feel more "high-end" and prestigious.

- **Bad Chat Options:** Private messaging is difficult and often breaks, so people have to move their conversations to WhatsApp.
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2. USE-CASES & CONTEXT ANALYSIS

- **The Weekend Planner:** People try to find local hangouts in Tier-2 a few times a week but only see national videos, so they switch to Instagram instead.
 - **The Hobbyist Hunt:** Users look for niche skills like art but only find viral funny videos.
 - **The Creator's Crisis:** Creators get bullied during live chats or in comments several times a week, forcing them to leave for "safer" apps.
 - **The Onboarding Trap:** New users in smaller towns try to sign up but never get the OTP code, so they never use the app again. We need to implement more login options, including a WhatsApp OTP option, to address this issue.
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3. MARKET POTENTIAL (TAM ESTIMATES)

- **Target Group:** 120 million young people (ages 16–25) in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.
 - **Key Focus:** 50 million active users who already share content to WhatsApp because they don't have a community inside the app.
 - **Goal:** By solving local and money problems, we can turn 20–30 million users into "Loyalists" who use VibeCircle as a helpful tool every day.
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4. PROPOSED SOLUTION: VIBECIRCLE

1. Modern and Simple Design

- The app has a clean, fresh look that is very easy to use.
- **Theme Switch:** You can easily change between **Light Mode** and **Dark Mode** whenever you want.
- **Clean Feed:** The clean UI of platforms like Instagram and YouTube works by minimizing visual clutter, which reduces decision fatigue and allows users to focus entirely on the content. This simple, modern design offers strong aesthetic appeal and is highly optimized for mobile screens, ensuring content is easily consumable. By removing distractions, the clean feed also significantly enhances the perceived value of the creator's work.

2. Local City Algorithm

- The app understands where you live (Tier-2) and automatically shows you things happening in your city.
- **Local Recommendations:** Your feed will suggest the best street food places, hidden tourist spots, upcoming music events, or local shopping markets in your area.
- **Local Heroes:** You will see videos from creators who live in your city. This helps you discover "what is trending in my city" instead of just seeing national viral videos.

3. Interest Groups

- Join big groups for things you love, like dancing, photography, or exam studies.
- People can talk, share tips, and show their work just like in Telegram groups. This helps you meet local people who share your hobbies.

4. Small Earning Section

- Earn money by teaching a small skill, like a 15-minute lesson or art tips.
- Charge a small fee (₹10 to ₹50) for your help.
- **Trust Dashboard:** A clear page to see how much you earned and withdraw it easily.

5. Support for Slow Internet

- The app works well even on slow mobile data; the app is optimized for low-bandwidth (Internet) environments and provides download and offline content saving features.
- It automatically saves group videos while you are on Wi-Fi, so you can watch them later without any loading.

6. Safety and Protection

- The app blocks bad words in local languages automatically.
- Strong safety tools protect creators, especially women, from being harassed in comments or chats.

7. Easy Sign-up

- Sign up quickly using WhatsApp to avoid waiting for SMS codes that never arrive.

5. GROWTH & ADOPTION STRATEGY (10M USERS IN YEAR 1)

- **Phase 1: Seed (Months 1–3):** Find 1,000 "leads" in colleges in cities like Tier-2 to start the first groups.
- **Phase 2: Viral Scale (Months 4–6):** Create a loop where you invite 3 friends via WhatsApp Status to join exclusive local groups.

- **Phase 3: National Presence (Months 7–12):** Work with phone companies like Jio to have the app pre-installed. Start "City vs. City" challenges to get the whole country talking.
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6. SUCCESS METRICS

A. Happiness (User Feelings)

- **Coolness Score (NPS (Net Promoter Score)):** Check if 16–25-year-olds think the app is "aspirational" and not "old".
- **Creator Trust:** Use surveys to see if creators feel the payments are clear and honest.

B. Engagement (Community Depth)

- **Group Time:** See if people are actually talking in interest groups instead of just scrolling.
 - **Local Discovery:** Track how many people engage with the local city recommendations in their feed.
 - **Internal Shares:** Track if people share content inside the app instead of just moving it to WhatsApp.
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7. RISKS & CONSTRAINTS

A. Content Risks

- **Fake Skills:** People might sell bad lessons.
- **Fix:** Use "Verified" badges and hold the money for 24 hours until the buyer is happy.
- **Managing Bullying:** It's hard to watch every group.
- **Fix:** Pay group leaders in app coins to keep their groups safe.

B. Safety Risks

- **Bullying and harassment,** especially for female creators.
- **Fix:** -Deploy AI-powered language filters for local dialects, inspire group leaders with in-app coins to moderate, and provide quick Report/Block tools.

C. Market Risks

- **Big Competitors:** Competition from global apps (Instagram, YouTube) copying features or drawing users away.
- **Fix:** Differentiate with regional language support, offline-first design, and hyperlocal discovery that global apps don't prioritize.

D. Technical Constraints

- **Slow networks and failed OTP sign-ups** in Tier-2/3 cities.

- Fix: Add Lite Mode for low-data usage, enable WhatsApp-based OTP fallback, and optimize caching for smoother performance.

E. Scalability Risks

- Risk: Rapid growth could strain moderation and community management.
- Fix: Build a community moderation system with tiered roles, reward active moderators, and gradually introduce AI-assisted group monitoring.

F. Adoption Risks

- Risk: Users may hesitate to leave their current platforms on which they are already laid on (e.g. Instagram, YouTube) or may not see immediate value.
- Fix: Position VibeCircle as a creator-first platform with micro-earning opportunities, and run City vs City challenges to build local pride and stickiness.

8. High Level Wire-Frames (Sample prototype)

VibeCircle - Connect. Create. Earn. Empowering youth in Tier-2 Indian cities through social connection and micro-entrepreneurship.

Sample Prototype (Figma):

<https://www.figma.com/make/0pOfUacWpPBFGvIuuvvOE/VibeCircle-Mobile-App-Wireframes?fullscreen=1&t=4k4LGZdUuKXAvYKF-1>

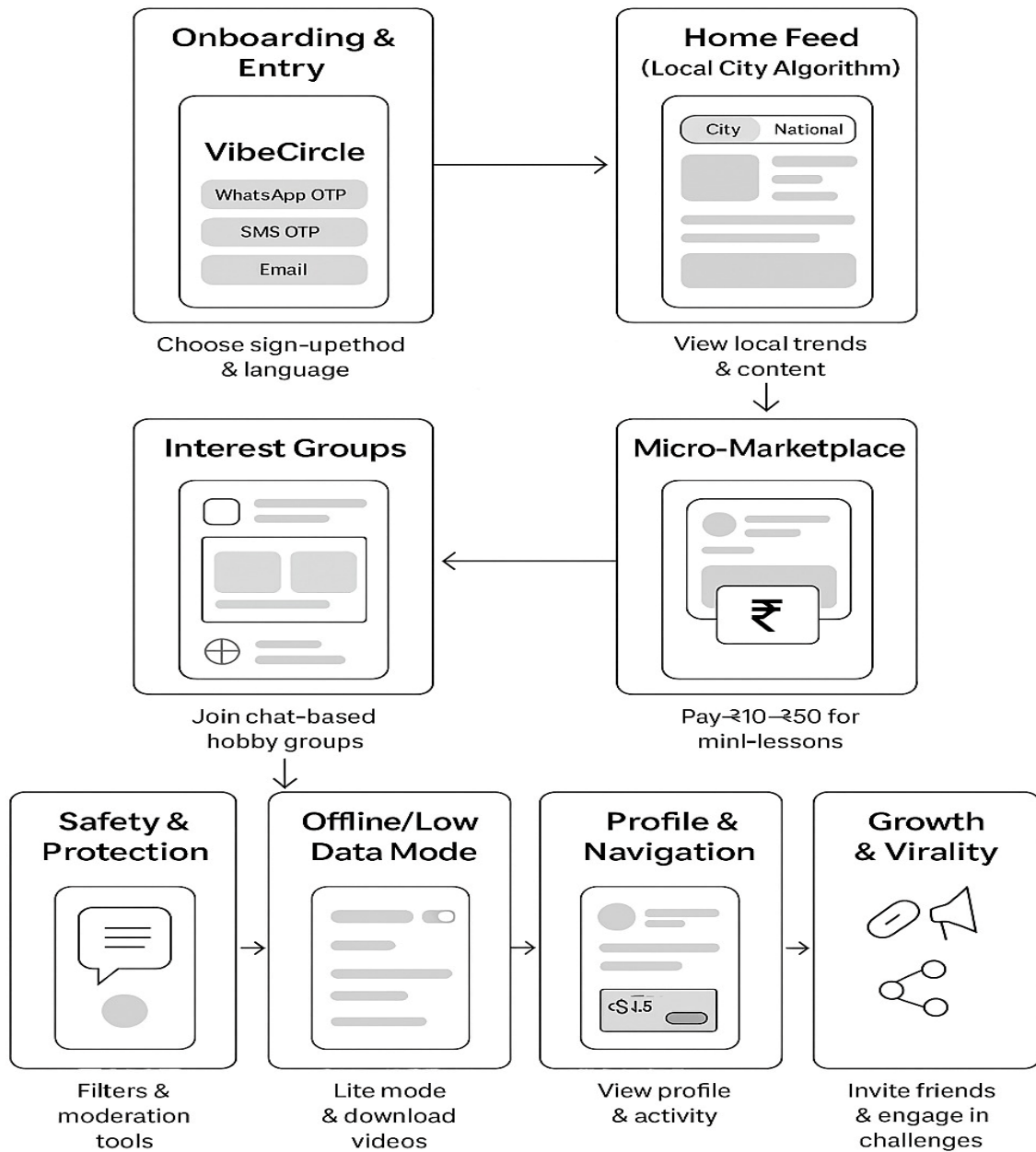
Design Principles:

- Mobile-First: All layouts optimized for phone screens (375x812px)
- Clean & Modern: Inspired by Instagram and YouTube's minimal design
- Accessibility: Regional language support throughout the app
- Low Data: Lite mode and offline features for Tier-2 connectivity
- Safety: Built-in moderation and user protection tools
- Monetization: Creator earnings through micro-marketplace
- Engagement: City-based algorithm and gamification features

Key Features:

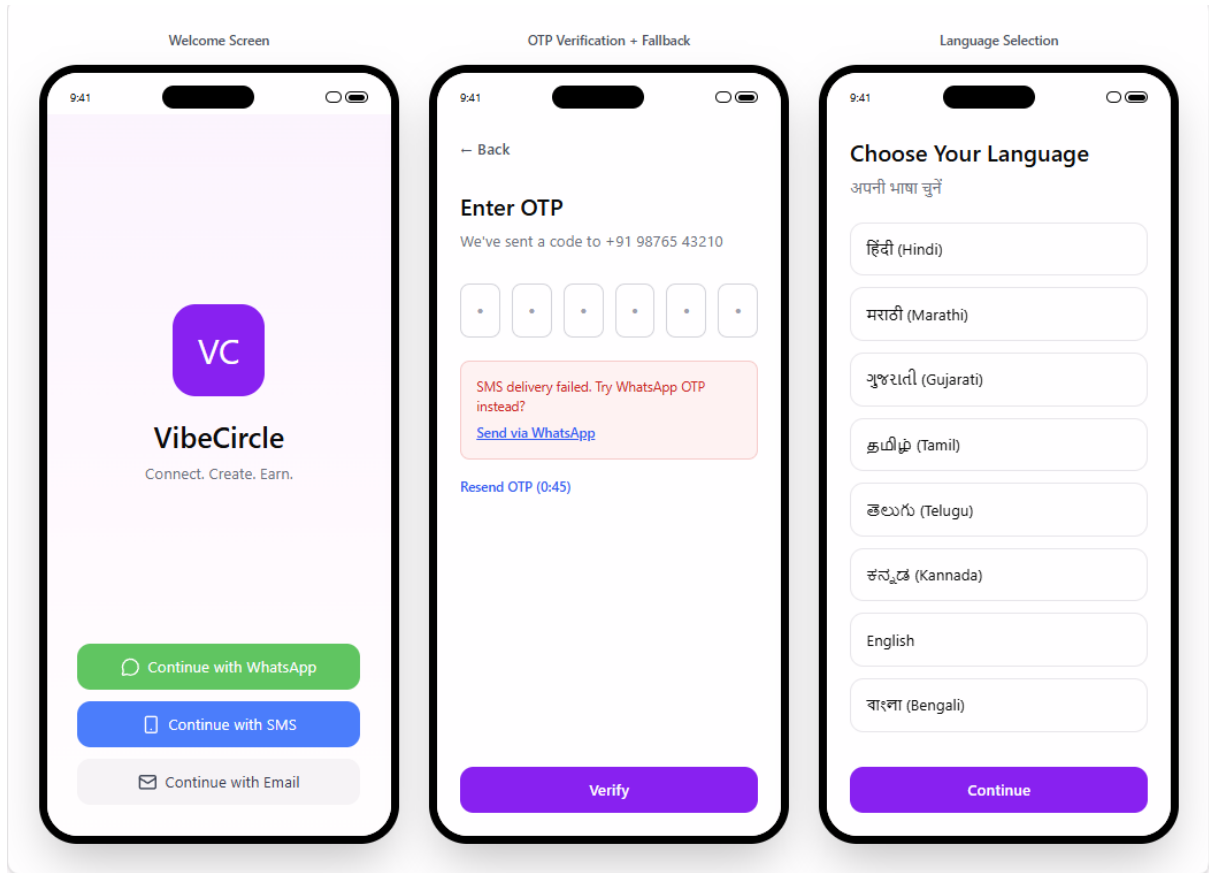
- WhatsApp/SMS OTP.
- City-based algorithm.
- Interest groups.
- Micro-payments (₹10-₹50).
- Regional language filters.
- Offline video mode.
- City challenges.

Product Work Flow:



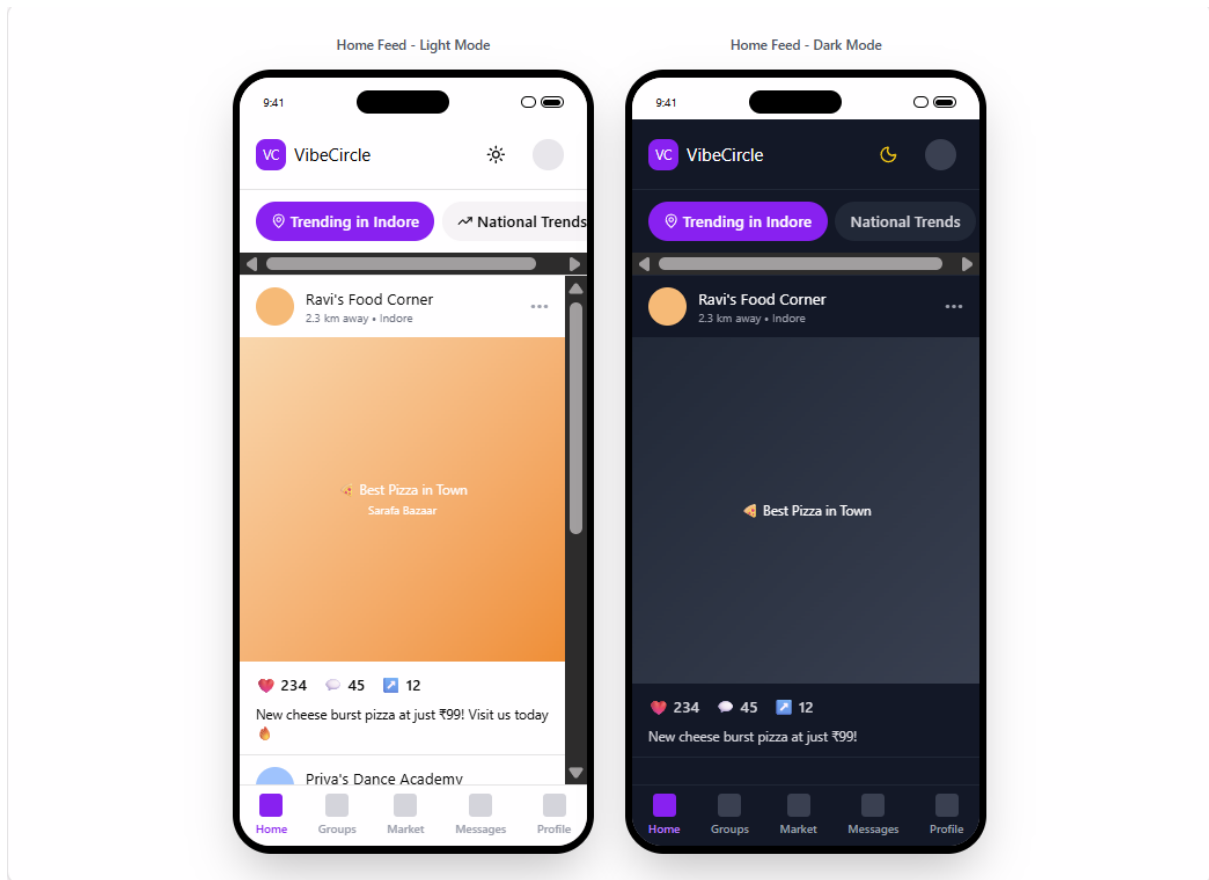
Navigation & Flow

- Bottom navigation bar: Home, Groups, Marketplace, Messages, Profile
- Profile page: user bio, earnings, group memberships, settings



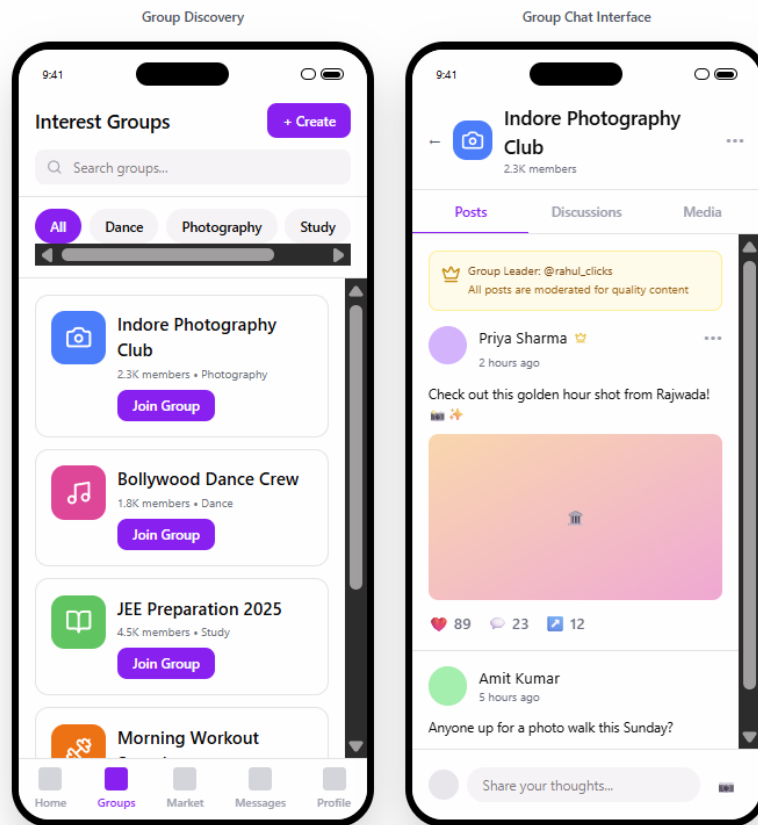
1. Onboarding & Sign-up

- Simple welcome screen with app logo and tagline ("Connect. Create. Earn.")
- Sign-up options: WhatsApp OTP, SMS OTP, or Email
- Error handling for failed SMS OTP with fallback to WhatsApp OTP
- Quick language selection (regional languages prioritized)



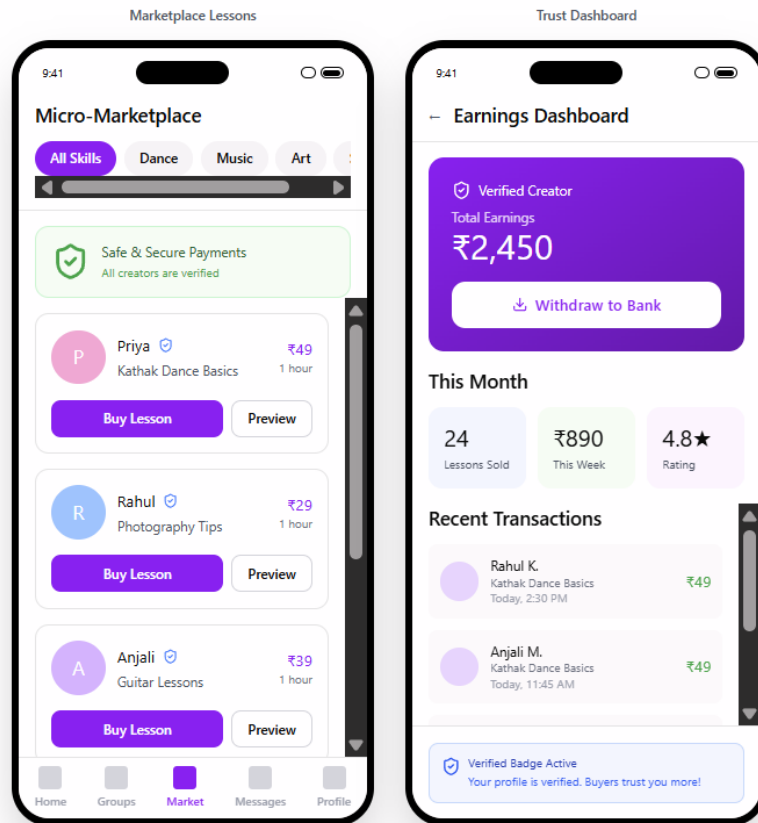
2. Home Feed (Local City Algorithm)

- Instagram-like clean feed with local recommendations (food spots, events, creators)
- Toggle between "Trending in My City" and "National Trends"
- Light/Dark mode switch in top-right corner



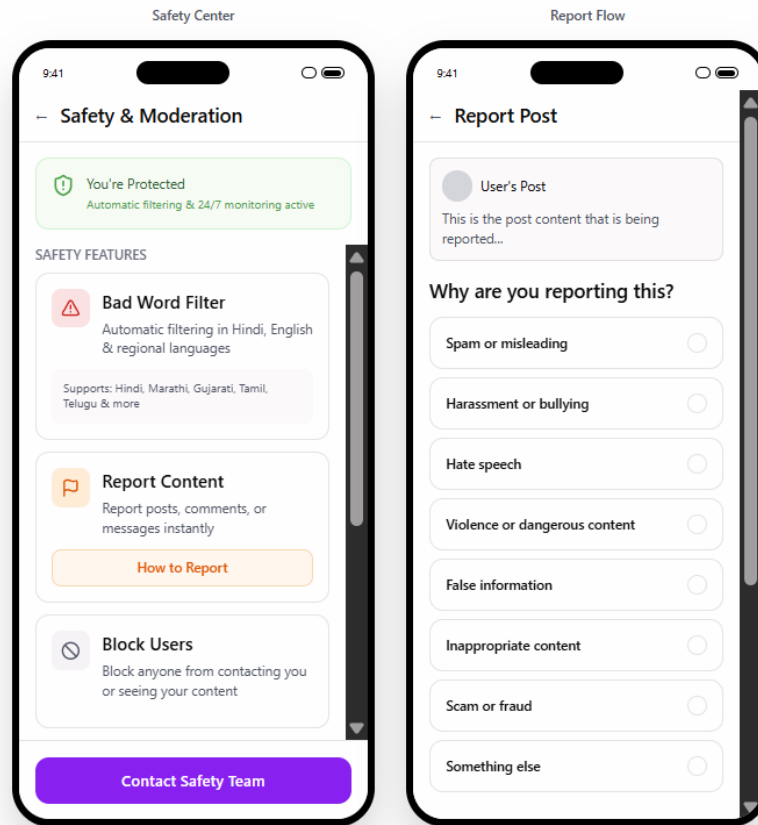
3. Interest Groups

- Group discovery page with categories (Dance, Photography, Exam Studies, etc.)
- Group chat interface similar to Telegram, with posts + discussions
- Option to create/join local hobby groups



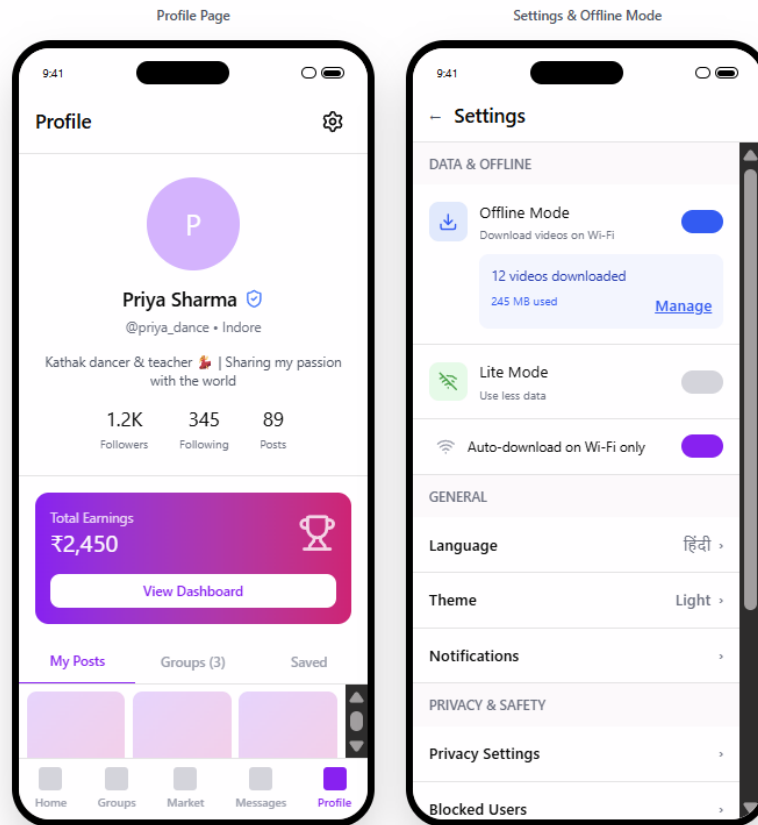
4. Micro-Marketplace (Small Earning Section)

- Marketplace tab with small paid lessons (₹10–₹50)
- Lesson cards: creator photo, skill title, price
- Trust Dashboard: earnings summary, withdrawal button, verified badge system



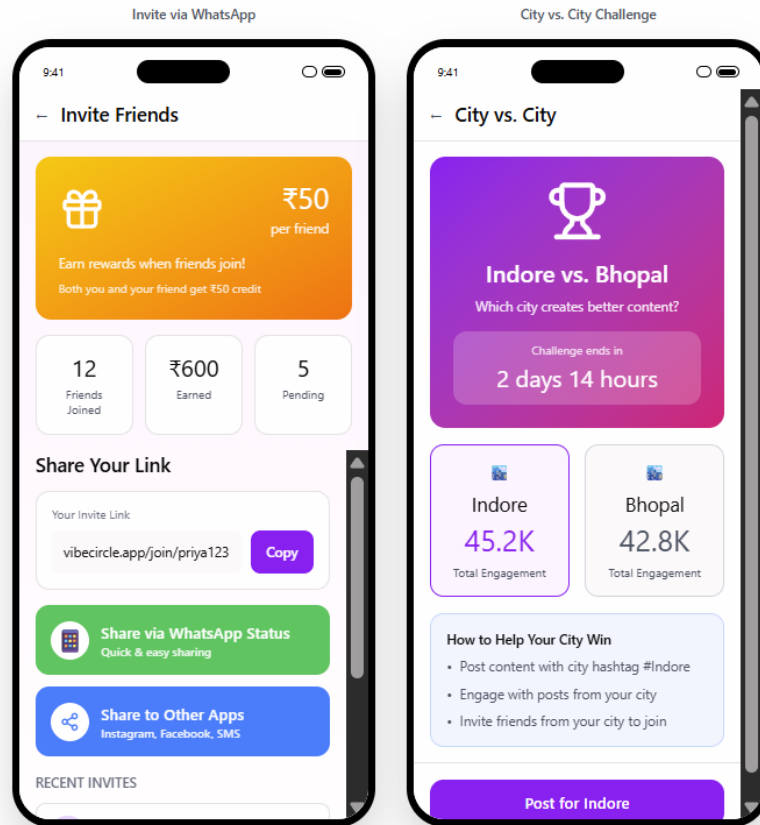
5. Safety & Protection

- Automatic bad-word filter in local languages
- Report/Block buttons on posts and chats
- Group leader badge for moderation



6. Offline/Low Data Mode

- Download videos on Wi-Fi for offline viewing
- Lite mode toggle in settings



7. Growth Features

- Invite friends via WhatsApp Status (share link button)
- "City vs. City" challenge banner in feed